

1.4 Unit 1, Option B: Power, Belief and Conflict in Early Modern Europe

Focus

This option concentrates on the themes of religious and political conflict in early modern Europe, with further emphasis on challenges to existing authority, how these developed and the extent to which they were resolved by the end of the periods studied. Whichever combinations are chosen, this option enables students to understand how inextricably intertwined were religious and political issues in 16th and 17th century western European societies.

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in *Appendix 1*.

Students entered for Option B are required to study TWO of the topics from B1-B7.

**B1 Luther,
Lutheranism
and the
German
Reformation,
1517-55**

- The causes of reformation in Germany: the state of the Catholic Church and extent of dissatisfaction with it in the early 16th century; the role of the Papacy.
- Martin Luther: his ideas and their impact; his overall influence in the German states to 1546.
- The expansion of Lutheranism within Germany and beyond to 1555.
- The political context of the German Reformation: the Holy Roman Empire; the roles of Charles V and the German princes.

**B2 Meeting the
Challenge?
The Catholic
Reformation,
c1540-1600**

- Catholic reform developments before 1545: the 5th Lateran Council and the Oratory of Divine Love; Ignatius Loyola and the Society of Jesus.
- The Council of Trent: its role, importance and impact to 1600. The work of reforming popes and the counter-attack on Protestant territory (Poland, Austria and Bavaria) to 1600.
- Attacks on heresy and proscriptions: the Inquisition and the Index.
- Support from Catholic rulers: Philip II of Spain, the Catholic League in France.

**B3 The Revolt
of the
Netherlands,
1559-1609**

- Political and religious origins of the Revolt; Spanish reactions to 1572; the role of Alba.
- The House of Orange: its significance within the Netherlands; the importance of its leadership; the role of William the Silent.
- Spanish reaction to the Revolt from 1572: the roles of Requesens; Don John of Austria and Parma; the separation of north and south.
- The later stages, 1579-1609: importance of English intervention; internationalisation of the struggle; the reasons for the survival of a Calvinist northern state.

B4 The European Witchcraze, c1580-c1650

- Reasons for growing intolerance of witches: instability of religious situation in Europe; links with heresy; fears of minorities; roots of mass hysteria.
- Social and economic factors: social and cultural characteristics of those accused of witchcraft; reasons for gender imbalance.
- Nature of witchcraft accusations and reasons for widespread belief in them.
- Geographical spread of witchcraft prosecutions and reasons for imbalances: importance of local issues; secular and ecclesiastical prosecutions; reasons for peaks and troughs.

B5 Conflict and Conquest in Ireland, 1598-1692

- English settlement in the later Elizabethan period: the Tyrone rebellion and the role of Essex.
- The Ulster plantation of the early 17th century: its nature and extent; the significance for Ireland of the accession of the Stuart monarchy.
- The Confederate War, 1641-53: its causes, course, outcome and impact; the roles of Ormond and Oliver Cromwell.
- Restoration Ireland: the significance of the Act of Settlement (1662) and Anglo-Irish trade; roles of Ormond and Tyrconnell; the significance for Ireland of the reign of James II and its aftermath to 1692.

B6 The Thirty Years War and its Impact on Continental Europe, 1618-60

- Origins of the war and reasons for outbreak of conflict: challenges to Habsburg power; religious divisions.
- The wars, 1618-30: Bohemia, the Palatinate and Denmark; course, significance and impact; the roles of Wallenstein and Emperor Ferdinand II.
- The wars of 1630-48: Sweden and Franco-Habsburg conflict; the roles of Ferdinand II and Ferdinand III; Tilly and Oxenstierna.
- The Treaty of Westphalia (1648): its significance and the legacy of the war to 1660 (political, economic, social and religious).